

MAJOR INITIATIVES

What the IT companies are doing on e-governance

TCS

Providing its technology to the External Affairs Ministry for the Passport Seva Project to automate issuance of passports and cut delays, as well as to the Home Ministry for police reform projects.

INFOSYS TECHNOLOGIES

Implementing the eBiz Project of the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion. Involves creating a platform to give the business community access to fast information and simplified procedures.

ORACLE

Partnering SBI and Sahaj on Financial Inclusion project to take banking services to NREGA beneficiaries through 28,000 CSCs.

MICROSOFT INDIA

Helping the government of Maharashtra to spread ICT adoption in education and build employability, and the Gujarat Government to provide affordable access for IT to university students and faculty.

CISCO

Collaborating with NIOS to introduce ICT curriculum in six selected vocational institutes and with the Railways for unreserved ticketing solution; Implementing SWAN and SDCs with many states.

WIPRO

Working on a project for Employees State Insurance Corporation which will connect 1,200 dispensaries, 400 hospitals and 100 offices.

A bulk of the contracts comes from the 27 Mission Mode Projects under the National e-Governance Plan. The plan offers the industry opportunities to use IT for improving efficiency of public services in transportation, healthcare, education, taxation, policing and judiciary among others. There are also e-infrastructure schemes like State Wide Area Network (SWAN) and State Data Centre (SDC). Of particular interest are the Finance Ministry's projects relating to Direct Tax Code, creation of a National Treasury Management Agency and Expenditure Information Network, the Education Department's e-learning initiative and the Rural Development Ministry's plans for e-panchayats and digitisation of land records. Of late, says Mittal, the excitement of the companies has swung to the Budget 2010 proposals on smart cards for NREGA and the Financial Inclusion Technology Fund.



R. CHANDRASEKHAR
Secretary, IT

“The slowdown made the IT sector look much more towards the domestic economy than in the past.”

“Of the \$11 billion revenue earned from India, 10 per cent comes from government projects.”



ANAND SANKARAN
Head-India and Middle East, Wipro

There is plenty of action in the states too, especially in Bihar, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh that had earlier been left out by the first wave of the IT revolution. If Bihar wants to computerise its public service commission, Orissa wants IT service providers to bring in hassle-free e-registration of sale and purchase of land. In Madhya Pradesh, Anurag Srivastava, additional secretary, IT Department, is leading an initiative to provide computers in 2,000 government schools. Also, all states are undertaking reforms in state electricity boards to curb transmission losses with the use of IT, for which they have set aside Rs 2,000 crore each.

Needless to say, the volume of business is huge. “The Government spending on an annual basis is to the order of Rs 4,000-5,000 crore. It has announced allocation of 2-3 per cent of annual budget outlays for IT,” says Chandrasekhar. According to Kapil Dev Singh of IDC, an IT advisory firm, the Government is estimated to have spent Rs 8,255 crore on IT this year, while in the pipeline for a 2011 roll-out are projects worth Rs 6,500 crore. Even CRISIL analysts see the Government becoming the top vertical of domestic IT service revenues by 2013-14, with share in services revenue climbing from 28 to 35 per cent in future. The reason for this happening only now, as Dilip Jha, vice-president of Mahindra Satyam, points out, is that in recent times, service providers have acquired a superior technological edge and are better equipped to serve the high-end and well-planned projects they find in India. Companies like Mahindra Satyam are creating separate units with a sales task force devoted to government projects and are trying to replicate the experience of handling governance projects in other parts of the world by bringing in best practices applied to such projects.

At Wipro, Sankaran is driving the company's presence in the healthcare space with a project for Employees State Insurance Corporation, which involves setting up a data centre and cre-

All figures are estimates. Source: TCS

Rs 696.12 cr

Rs 477.40 cr

Rs 299.76 cr